THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
HKU BUSINESS SCHOOL

MSMK7011 Service Marketing and Management (2026-27 Module 3)

GENERAL INFORMATION			
Instructor	Dr. Buston CHU		
Office	KKL 103	**Telephone No.**	3917 7763
Email	buston@hku.hk	**Consultation times**:	Saturday 17:00-18:00 (By appointment)
Pre-requisites Course Code & Title	N.A.	**Co-requisites Course Code & Title**	N.A.
Tutor	(No Tutorials)		
Other important details:	**Time:** Wednesday & Saturday– (**Section A)** 09:30 – 12:30; **(Section B)** 14:00 – 17:00 **Venue:** ATC		

COURSE DESCRIPTION

Much of the global economy has increasingly been dominated by services. In Hong Kong, the services sector accounts for over 93% of its GDP and it is among the most developed in East Asia. More and more companies, brand marketers and even manufacturing giants, shift their focus to services that create competitive advantages for promising profit potential in the experience economy. This trend accelerates with the digital transformation around consumers' and business enterprises' daily routines. Yet, marketing and managing services to achieve service excellence represents a major challenge for firms because it requires changes in management mind-set and company culture, changes in human resources management, and new ways of designing and implementing customer solutions.

This course is designed to help students acquire the necessary knowledge and skills to achieve service excellence in an organization. The course materials are equally applicable to organizations in service industries (e.g., banks & financial, transportation, hospitality, education, professional services, telecommunication, etc.) and to organizations that depend on service excellence for competitive advantage (e.g., high technology, automotive, industrial products, etc.).

This course considers service excellence as a corporate strategic vision and views effective service strategy from an integrative perspective that covers customers, employees, and operations. Keeping a service organization successful and growing requires more than just effective marketing. Organizations committed to achieve excellence in service must integrate innovative services marketing with effective human resources management and efficient operations management. Course content focuses on understanding and managing customer expectations and evaluations of services; designing services that meet or exceed customer expectations; delivering and performing quality services through people and operations; pricing of services; managing customer complaints and service recovery; and building & managing customer relationships. Students will also learn effective service marketing and management tools such as service audit through gap analysis, service quality and customer satisfaction survey, service blueprinting, etc.

DCOURSE OBJECTIVES

1. To understand the unique challenges inherent in marketing and managing services.
2. To develop the essential skills for effective marketing and management of services.
3. To learn how to attract, develop, and retain loyal customers through delivering service excellence.

PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES

PLO1: Acquisition and internalization of knowledge of the programme discipline
PLO2: Application and integration of knowledge
PLO3: Inculcating professionalism and leadership
PLO4: Developing Global Outlook
PLO5: Mastering communication skills

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES	
Course Learning Outcomes	**Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes**
CLO1: Develop skills in performing analyses on customers' service expectations & requirements, service process and operations.	PLO1, PLO4
CLO2: Apply service marketing tools such as service quality & customer satisfaction survey, service blueprinting, etc. to address service problems.	PLO1, PLO2
CLO3: Develop managerial leadership and competency in managing a service operation.	PLO1, PLO2, PLO3, PLO4
CLO4: Develop skills in case analysis and writing, presentation, and teamwork.	PLO2, PLO4, PLO5

COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES

The course will be delivered in workshop mode via a blend of short lectures and interactive class discussions, case analyses, and active learning exercises. A services marketing group project will be used to help students assume the role of a consulting team and develop in-depth insights and practical experience on conducting a comprehensive and thorough investigation into a specific aspect of a company's service marketing and management operations.

T&L1. Interactive Class Lectures/Discussions

Interactive presentations with PowerPoint slides will be provided by the instructor to explain and illustrate key concepts. Students will be invited and encouraged to share their view and experience in class discussions. **(Targeted CLOs: CLO1, CLO2, and CLO3)**

T&L2. In-class Exercises

In-class exercises will be used to deepen students' learning and develop their application capability on specific topics. Students are expected to work in groups to address issues posted in these exercises and share their thoughts in class discussions. **(Targeted CLOs: CLO1, CLO2, CLO3, and CLO4)**

T&L3. Case Analysis and Discussion

Case analysis and discussion will be used to develop students' capacity to identify major issues/problems in diverse business settings, undertake systematic investigation to obtain relevant information, and apply service marketing concepts and tools to make sound decisions. **(Targeted CLOs: CLO1, CLO2, CLO3, and CLO4)**

T&L4. Individual Assignment

The individual assignment is designed to help students gain hand-on experience in understanding incidents of customer service experience (both positive and negative), developing implications from analyzing these incidents, and providing recommendations for service improvement. **(Targeted CLOs: CLO1, CLO2, and CLO3)**

T&L5. Service Marketing Group Project

The Service Marketing Group Project is designed to help students assume the role of a consulting team and develop in-depth insights and practical experience on conducting a comprehensive and thorough investigation on a specific aspect of a company's service marketing and management operations. **(Targeted CLOs: CLO1, CLO2, CLO3, and CLO4)**

Course Teaching and Learning Activities	**Expected contact hour**	**Aligned Course Learning Outcomes**
T&L1. Interactive Class Lectures/Discussions	30	CLO1, CLO2, & CLO3
T&L2. In-class Exercice		CLO1, CLO2, CLO3, & CLO4
T&L3. Case Analysis and Discussion	25	CLO1, CLO2, CLO3, & CLO4
T&L4. Individual Assignment	15	CLO1, CLO2, & CLO3
T&L5. Service Marketing Group Project	50	CLO1, CLO2, CLO3, & CLO4
Total	**120**	

COURSE ASSESSMENT METHODS

Students' course performance will be assessed by a combination of individual (50%) and group (50%) works. The table below presents the weighting for each assessment task and the alignment of assessment tasks with teaching and learning activities and course learning outcomes:

Assessment Methods	Brief Description (Optional)	Weight	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes
A1. Class Participation		25%	CLO1, CLO2, CLO3, & CLO4
A2. Individual Assignment		25%	CLO1, CLO2, & CLO3
A3. Services Marketing Group Project • Project Proposal (5%) • Project Presentation (20%) • Project Report (25%)		50%	CLO1, CLO2, CLO3, & CLO4
Total		**100%**	

STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT

Course Grade Descriptors

The following general grading rubrics will be used to assess students' overall course performance and performance in each of the above three assessment tasks.

A+, A, A-	Very good to excellent performance on most or all assessment tasks.
B+, B, B-	Good to very good performance on most or all assessment tasks.
C+, C, C-	Fair to good performance on most or all assessment tasks.
D+, D	Fair performance on most or all assessment tasks.
F	Poor performance on most or all assessment tasks.

Assessment Rubrics for Each Assessment

A1. Class Participation

A+, A, A-	B+, B, B-	C+, C, C-	D+, D	F
▪ Contribute to class discussions and activities actively and consistently ▪ Always provide very clear, accurate, relevant and helpful examples and analyses ▪ Always suggest creative and insightful solutions ▪ Always raise thoughtful questions ▪ Provide very good to excellent synthesis across readings and discussions ▪ Expand the class's perspective significantly	▪ Contribute to class discussions and activities actively and regularly ▪ Provide clear, accurate, relevant and helpful examples and analyses regularly ▪ Suggest creative solutions regularly ▪ Raising thoughtful questions regularly ▪ Provide good to very good synthesis across readings and discussions ▪ Expanding the class's perspective to a great extent	▪ Contribute to class discussions and activities occasionally ▪ Providing clear, accurate, relevant and helpful examples and analyses occasionally ▪ Suggesting creative solutions occasionally ▪ Raising thoughtful questions occasionally ▪ Provide fair to good synthesis across readings and discussions ▪ Expanding the class's perspective to some extent	▪ Almost never contribute to class discussions and activities ▪ Providing mostly unclear, inaccurate, and irrelevant examples and analyses ▪ Almost never suggest any creative solutions ▪ Almost never raise any thoughtful questions ▪ Provide fair synthesis across readings and discussions ▪ Almost never expand the class's perspective	▪ Never contribute to class discussions and activities ▪ Always provide unclear, inaccurate, and irrelevant examples and analyses ▪ Never suggest any creative solutions ▪ Never raise any thoughtful questions ▪ Provide poor synthesis across readings and discussions ▪ Never expand the class's perspective

A2. Individual Assignment

A+, A, A-	B+, B, B-	C+, C, C-	D+, D	F
▪ Reported incidents have very good to excellent match with selection criteria ▪ Always provide very clear, accurate, and relevant descriptions of the incidents ▪ Always provide	▪ Reported incidents have good to very good match with selection criteria ▪ Provide clear, accurate, and relevant descriptions of the incidents regularly ▪ Provide	▪ Reported incidents have fair to good match with selection criteria ▪ Provide clear, accurate, and relevant descriptions of the incidents occasionally ▪ Provide comprehensive	▪ Reported incidents have fair match with selection criteria ▪ Provide mostly unclear, inaccurate, and irrelevant descriptions of the incidents ▪ Almost never provide	▪ Reported incidents have poor match with selection criteria ▪ Always provide unclear, inaccurate, and irrelevant descriptions of the incidents ▪ Never provide

comprehensive and insightful analysis on the incidents ▪ Derive very good to excellent implications from analysis on the incidents ▪ Provide very relevant and effective recommendations for service improvement	comprehensive and insightful analysis on the incidents regularly ▪ Derive good to very good implications from analysis on the incidents ▪ Provide largely relevant and effective recommendations for service improvement	and insightful analysis on the incidents occasionally ▪ Derive fair to good implications from analysis on the incidents ▪ Provide somewhat relevant and effective recommendations for service improvement	comprehensive and insightful analysis on the incidents ▪ Derive fair implications from analysis on the incidents ▪ Provide mostly irrelevant and ineffective recommendations for service improvement	comprehensive and insightful analysis on the incidents ▪ Derive poor implications from analysis on the incidents ▪ Never provide any relevant or effective recommendations for service improvement
A3a. Project Presentation				
A+, A, A-	B+, B, B-	C+, C, C-	D+, D	F
▪ Very good to excellent organization of presentation materials ▪ Always very clear and fluent presentation ▪ Excellent management of presentation time, pace, and tone ▪ Demonstrate a consistently very high level of creativity, confidence, and enthusiasm ▪ Excellent engagement of the audience ▪ Excellent skill and capability in handling Q&A	▪ Good to very good organization of presentation materials ▪ Mostly very clear and fluent presentation ▪ Very good management of presentation time, pace, and tone ▪ Demonstrate a consistently high level of creativity, confidence, and enthusiasm ▪ Very good engagement of the audience ▪ Very good skill and capability in handling Q&A	▪ Fair to good organization of presentation materials ▪ Somewhat clear and fluent presentation ▪ Good management of presentation time, pace, and tone ▪ Demonstrate a somewhat high level of creativity, confidence, and enthusiasm ▪ Good engagement of the audience ▪ Good skill and capability in handling Q&A	▪ Fair organization of presentation materials ▪ Mostly unclear and not fluent presentation ▪ Fair management of presentation time, pace, and tone ▪ Demonstrate a low level of creativity, confidence, and enthusiasm ▪ Fair engagement of the audience ▪ Fair skill and capability in handling Q&A	▪ Poor organization of presentation materials ▪ Totally unclear and not fluent presentation ▪ Poor management of presentation time, pace, and tone ▪ Demonstrate no creativity, confidence, and enthusiasm ▪ Poor engagement of the audience ▪ Poor skill and capability in handling Q&A
A3b. Project Report				
A+, A, A-	B+, B, B-	C+, C, C-	D+, D	F
Executive Summary: ▪ Very comprehensive, precise, clear, and fluency summary of the purpose of the study, research conducted, key findings, and key recommendations *Overview:* ▪ Very comprehensive, precise, and clear descriptions of the company background, focus of the project, research conducted, and methodology used *Service/Customers/Competition:* ▪ Very comprehensive, precise, and clear discussions of the company' s service, customers, and competition ▪ All or almost all critical issues related to the company' s service, customers, and competition are clearly and accurately identified *Specific Topic of Investigation:* ▪ Very comprehensive, precise, and clear discussions of findings related to the managerial questions to be addressed by the project ▪ Demonstrate very	*Executive Summary*: ▪ Generally comprehensive, precise, clear, and fluency summary of the purpose of the study, research conducted, key findings, and key recommendations *Overview:* ▪ Generally comprehensive, precise, and clear descriptions of the company background, focus of the project, research conducted, and methodology used *Service/Customers/Competition:* ▪ Generally comprehensive, precise, and clear discussions of the company' s service, customers, and competition ▪ Most critical issues related to the company' s service, customers, and competition are clearly and accurately identified *Specific Topic of Investigation:* ▪ Generally comprehensive, precise, and clear discussions of findings related to the	*Executive Summary:* ▪ Moderately comprehensive, precise, clear, and fluency summary of the purpose of the study, research conducted, key findings, and key recommendations *Overview:* ▪ Moderately comprehensive, precise, and clear descriptions of the company background, focus of the project, research conducted, and methodology used *Service/Customers/Competition:* ▪ Moderately comprehensive, precise, and clear discussions of the company' s service, customers, and competition ▪ Some critical issues related to the company' s service, customers, and competition are clearly and accurately identified *Specific Topic of Investigation:* ▪ Moderately comprehensive, precise, and clear discussions of findings related to	*Executive Summary:* ▪ Adequately comprehensive, precise, clear, and fluency summary of the purpose of the study, research conducted, key findings, and key recommendations *Overview:* ▪ Adequately comprehensive, precise, and clear descriptions of the company background, focus of the project, research conducted, and methodology used *Service/Customers/Competition:* ▪ Adequately comprehensive, precise, and clear discussions of the company' s service, customers, and competition ▪ Few critical issues related to the company' s service, customers, and competition are clearly and accurately identified *Specific Topic of Investigation:* ▪ Adequately comprehensive, precise, and clear discussions of findings related to the	*Executive Summary:* ▪ Inadequate, inaccurate, unclear, and not fluent summary of the purpose of the study, research conducted, key findings, and key recommendations *Overview:* ▪ Inadequate, inaccurate, and unclear descriptions of the company background, focus of the project, research conducted, and methodology used *Service/Customers/Competition:* ▪ Inadequate, inaccurate, and unclear discussions of the company' s service, customers, and competition ▪ Very few or no critical issues related to the company' s service, customers, and competition are clearly and accurately identified *Specific Topic of Investigation:* ▪ Inadequate, inaccurate, and unclear discussions of findings related to the managerial questions to be addressed by the project

insightful, critical, thorough, systematic, and consistent analyses, with sufficient supports of relevant and helpful fact/data, and effective application of appropriate concepts /techniques/examples that are very well integrated with the analysis *Conclusions/Recommendations:* ▪ Very comprehensive, precise, and clear discussions of conclusions and recommendations ▪ All or almost all discussions follow logically from analyses and findings	managerial questions to be addressed by the project ▪ Demonstrate generally insightful, critical, thorough, systematic, and consistent analyses, with generally sufficient supports of relevant and helpful fact/data, and generally effective application of appropriate concepts /techniques/examples that are well integrated with the analysis *Conclusions/Recommendations:* ▪ Generally comprehensive, precise, and clear discussions of conclusions and recommendations ▪ Most discussions follow logically from analyses and findings	the managerial questions to be addressed by the project ▪ Demonstrate moderately insightful, critical, thorough, systematic, and consistent analyses, with moderately sufficient supports of relevant and helpful fact/data, and moderately effective application of appropriate concepts /techniques/examples that are somewhat integrated with the analysis *Conclusions/Recommendations:* ▪ Moderately comprehensive, precise, and clear discussions of conclusions and recommendations ▪ Some discussions follow logically from analyses and findings	managerial questions to be addressed by the project ▪ Demonstrate adequately insightful, critical, thorough, systematic, and consistent analyses, with adequately sufficient supports of relevant and helpful fact/data, and adequately effective application of appropriate concepts /techniques/examples that have little integration with the analysis *Conclusions/Recommendations:* ▪ Adequately comprehensive, precise, and clear discussions of conclusions and recommendations ▪ Few discussions follow logically from analyses and findings	▪ Demonstrate inadequate, irrelevant, scant, unsystematic, and inconsistent analyses, with insufficient supports of relevant and helpful fact/data, and ineffective application of appropriate concepts /techniques/examples that have no integration with the analysis *Conclusions/Recommendations:* ▪ Inadequate, inaccurate, and unclear discussions of conclusions and recommendations ▪ Very few or no discussions follow logically from analyses and findings

COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE			
Date	**Topics**	**Assigned Text**	**Assignment Due Date**
Dec 2	**1. INTRODUCING SERVICES MARKETING** • Service and Marketing Trend • Challenges of Service Marketing • Service Characteristics and Implications	Ch 1	
Dec 5	**2. ACHIEVING SERVICE EXCELLENCE: CLOSING THE GAPS** • The Customer Gap • The Provider Gaps	Ch 2	**Group Member List: *Dec 8***
Dec 9	**3. FOCUSING ON THE CUSTOMER** • Customer Expectations & Perceptions of Service • Service Quality • Customer Satisfaction vs. Delight	Ch 3, 4	
Dec 12	**4. UNDERSTANDING CUSTOMER THROUGH SERVICE RESEARCH** • Effective Service Research Program	Ch 5 Case 1	**Group Project Proposal: *Dec 12***
Dec 16	**5. ALIGNING SERVICE DESIGN** • Service Innovation & Design • Service Blueprinting • Servicescape	Ch 8, 10	
Dec 19	**6. DELIVERING & PERFORMING SERVICES** • Roles of Employees & Customers in Service Delivery • Managing Capacity & Demand	Ch 11,12 Ch 13 Case 2	**Individual Assignment: Dec 22**
Jan 2	**7. BUILDING PROFITABLE RELATIONSHIPS AND MANAGING SERVICE RECOVERY** • Loyalty and Relationship Marketing • Customer Complaints and Defection • Service Recovery	Ch 6, 7	
Jan 6	**8. BUILDING SERVICE BRAND** • Branded Service Experience • Employee-Brand Alignment		
Jan 9	**9. PRICING SERVICES FOR PROFITS** • Challenges of Service Pricing • Cost-based & Value-based Pricing	Ch 15	
	GROUP PRESENTATION		
Jan 13	**GROUP PRESENTATION**		**Group Project Report: *Jan 20***

REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS

Required Textbook(s) – *Services Marketing: Integrating Customer Focus Across the Firm, by V.A. Zeithaml, M.J. Bitner, and D.D. Gremler, McGraw-Hill, 8th edition, 2023. (ZBG)*

Recommend Textbook(s) or Suggested Reading(s) – *Cases and readings. (CP)*

Case 1 - "Understanding the role of artificial intelligence in personalized marketing", Kumar, Rajan, Venkatesan, and Lecinski (2019), Harvard Business Publishing
Case 2 – "Don't Manage Waits, Manage Experiences", Bitran, Gabriel Ferrer, Juan Carlos Rocha e Oliveira, Paulo, IESE Insight. 2009, Issue 1, p58-65.
Case 3 - "Are you undervaluing your customers" , Markey, Rob. Harvard Business Review. Jan/Feb2020, Vol. 98 Issue 1, p42-50.

MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

The SFTL questionnaire

COURSE POLICY

Academic Dishonesty:
The University Regulations on academic dishonesty will be strictly enforced. Please check the University Statement on plagiarism on the web: http://www.hku.hk/plagiarism/
Academic dishonesty is behavior in which a deliberately fraudulent misrepresentation is employed in an attempt to gain undeserved intellectual credit, either for oneself or for another.
Where a candidate for a degree or other award uses the work of another person or persons without due acknowledgement:
1. *The relevant Board of Examiners may impose a penalty in relation to the seriousness of the offence;*
2. *The relevant Board of Examiners may report the candidate to the Senate, where there is prima facie evidence of an intention to deceive and where sanctions beyond those in (1) might be invoked.*

To avoid intellectual property and copyright infringement, and/or violation of the Personal Data (Privacy) Ordinance, DO NOT upload HKU teaching-related materials including but not limited to course materials to websites.

All written reports should be submitted in electronic form to the Teaching Assistant and professor before the due date/time. All submitted written reports will be subjected to Turnitin to check for possible plagiarism. A penalty of 20% per day will be imposed on late submission.

ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION

Instructor's Background

Dr. Buston CHU is a veteran marketer and a business leader in service industry of Hong Kong. He has extensive marketing management experience for over twenty years, covering strategic planning, corporate and services marketing, customer relationship and experience management, research, service quality enhancement, as well as contact center management. Currently, Buston is a management consultant with special focus on service management and marketing.

Buston is recognized as an advocate of customer service excellence in Hong Kong. He is the Honorary Advisor (Former Chairman) of HK Association for Customer Service Excellence (HKACE), Former Chairman of HK Institute of Marketing, and the member in a number of industry and public services advisory boards, including Hong Kong Committee for Pacific Economic Cooperation, Advisory Committee of Travel Agents, Tourism Commission; Promotion & Consultation Subcommittee of Retail Industry Training Advisory Committee, Qualifications Framework, etc.

Buston is a seasoned corporate communications professional performing the spokesperson's role in different corporations and associations. He has extensive media and public relations experience. Buston is a frequent speaker and moderator/facilitator in forums, seminars and workshops of reputable organizations, as well as radio programme. He has been engaging in communication and presentation training for salespeople, marketing and customer service personnel over the past two decades.

Buston has been actively engaged in tertiary education, teaching services marketing and brand management in various universities as Adjunct Professor and Visiting Lecturer, including: The University of Hong Kong, HK Baptist University, and HK Polytechnic University.

Buston holds a Doctor degree in Business Administration, with research interests in services marketing, organizational and customer citizenship behaviours, as well as corporate social responsibility.